Ouroboros



12.2.25 - 24.10.25

Charlie Pegg

In the exhaustion of escape,

the mind will consume

anything

to satiate the

hunger,

itself included.

Table of Contents:

Pg.3 - Eternity.

Pg.4 - Rationale.

Pg.5 - A walk into new life...

Pg.7 - Sunset.

Pg.9 - We dream of what we don't have, I dream of my life.

Pg.11 - Someone needs an apology.

Pg.12 - An unfortunate meeting.

Pg.13 - So close to Heaven, so close to Hell.

Pg.15 - Cognitive dissonance.

Pg.16 - Destiny.

Pg.18 - Young Girl A.

Pg.19 - I still want to be a part of this world.

Pg.21 - ...A walk into same death...

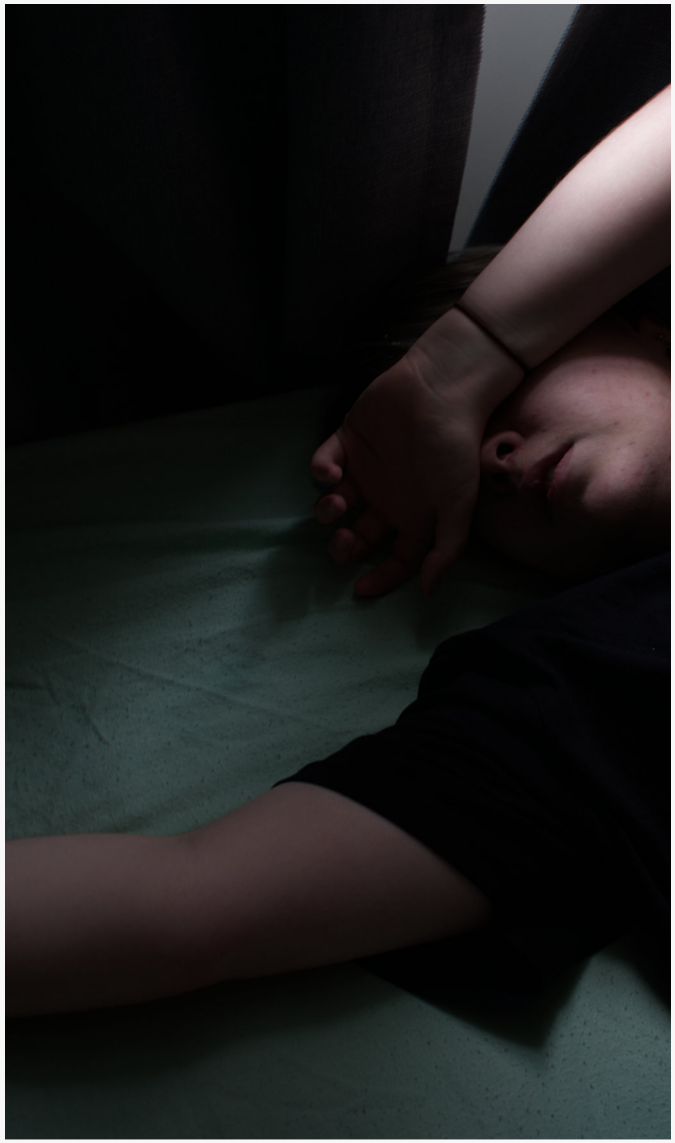
Pg.23 - Damned.

Pg.25 - Gifted child.

Pg.27 - ...Either way, I find no success.

Pg.29 - Closing remarks.

Eternity.



Rationale:

For this project, I wanted to visually express my experience with heavy escapism from 2025 and how it affected me mentally as a bit of a case study of sorts as to what escapism can look like when you go into it but never come out.

I took notes and experiences I remembered from last year and used them as the groundwork for what this project would look like and what I want people to experience upon viewing it -

a slow breaking of the mind under never ending days of nothing,

the warping of time,

the slow detachment from yourself,

the endless consumption,

and the wait for

anything.

Ouroboros is a being that constantly eats its own tail. I titled this piece as such as it mirrored my constant consumption of everything in my escapism, including my thoughts.

I wanted to use emotive photography for this zine and I chose to have my text be broken apart to emphasise that psychological feeling. However, I also wanted the zine to have a clinical feeling to it so the emotions can stand out more, so I gave it more classic professional typefaces and a bit of a clean cut appearance to achieve this.

A walk into new life...







I began 2025 with many plans.

I would get a job.

I would figure out what I wanted from life.

I would get a driver's license.

I would improve myself.

I would become the success I was always told I was.

But whatever god or gods or fates there may be decided that wouldn't be my life.

I needed to drown.

I believe my escapism started about 12.2.25. When plans fell through and feelings of worthlessness I held started to boil over, I found myself too scared to face the world.

Sunset.


"My new sun is a beautiful being.
My new sun is always here." - 23.3.25

We dream of what we don't have, I dream of my life.



"These days, I find myself stalking my
past life, wondering if

maybe
I could get those
moments of life brought back to me.

I would hate them,

but I would prefer them to this

purgatory.

Maybe this was all I was meant to be?

Maybe I was never meant to live beyond
this point.

I spend my days now not knowing
which day
is which, only knowing the releases
of new chapters to the Webtoons I read

as I dream
of life
I no longer have."- 14.4.25

Someone needs an apology.



"Oh, everyone was so excited to meet me,
there was so much anticipation, so much
eagerness

And yet, here's their return.

You are disappointed to
become me?
I am equally disappointed.

Maybe even more so.

The motivation to change left long ago.

They wanted a return that
mattered. I don't blame them.

If I were given the option,

An unfortunate meeting.



I would leave me too." - 16.5.25

So close to Heaven, so close to Hell.



Cognitive dissonance.

Destiny.



"I want to move.

I want to move.
I want to move.
I

want

to

move." -12.6.25

"I believe I've reached my breaking point,
or I've long ignored it.

Crying brings no relief or catharsis;

it is no longer abnormal.

I don't want to stay like this.

I really don't.

However I have no motivation to move.

All I can do is

Sink.

Fade.

Fall into obscurity.

I can only exist as if

'I'

had never existed at all." - 19.6.25

Young Girl A.



I still want to be a part of this world.



"I'm sorry.

I'm really sorry.

I wish I could do something.

It's not fair to us that I can't.

I'm really sorry." - ■.■.25


"I was once told by someone I deeply admired that
I had a mind unlike
anyone else they'd met.
I held it so deep in my heart.
I never wanted to let it go.
But I guess they were wrong, because
if I really am so special...


Damned.
...Then why don't I
care that I'm
slipping
away?"

Gifted child.



"You
are
not
allowed
to
die."

- 8.8.25

...Either way, I find no success.



On 24.10.25, I slowly got brought out of my heavy escapism after getting hired at a bank. I was in that headspace for approximately 8 months, even though it never felt like it.

My motivation to attempt to return to reality came from a conversation I had with a friend on 8.8.25, which made me realise that I needed to find a way out.

But even now, one year later,

that place, that headspace,
that isolation,

it seeps into my thoughts,
my actions,
my words,

it follows me

everywhere.